

AN UNUSUAL SUNDAY

Monday morning was always the hardest day for Natan.

His alarm rang loudly. With his eyes still heavy with sleep, he quickly got ready for school. After school ended, Natan still had activities to attend, assignments to complete, and various other responsibilities waiting for him.

The same thing happened on Tuesday, Wednesday, Thursday, and Friday.

His days were almost always filled with schedules.

Natan did not actually dislike all of his activities. He enjoyed studying, spending time with his friends, and participating in school activities. However, the more activities he had, the more he needed valuable time to rest. Because of this, he often thought that Saturday and Sunday were the most precious days of the week.

"Saturday and Sunday are my time!" he would think whenever Friday afternoon arrived.

Natan then remembered his three close friends, Jones, Darwin, and Mateo. They often played together after school.

One Friday afternoon, they were sitting in the schoolyard while discussing their plans for the weekend.

"Let's play football tomorrow!" Jones said enthusiastically.

"Sounds good!" Mateo replied.

Darwin laughed. "What about Sunday?"

Natan immediately answered, "I want to rest on Sunday."

Jones looked confused. "Don't you usually go to church?"

Natan sighed.

"That's the problem. I actually don't want to."

"Why?" Darwin asked.

"Because I'm already busy from Monday to Friday. On Saturday, I want to play. Sunday should be a day for sleeping, playing, and doing whatever I want. If I have to go to church, my holiday time will be reduced."

Mateo was silent for a moment.

"Isn't church only for a short time?" he asked.

"It's not about how long it takes," Natan replied. "I just want to have one day that is completely free."

His three friends did not argue with him. They simply continued discussing their plans to play on Saturday.

Finally, Saturday arrived.

Natan woke up later than usual. There was no school uniform to wear, no assignment that had to be completed immediately, and no alarm waking him up early.

He spent the day playing with Jones, Darwin, and Mateo. They played football, joked around, and enjoyed their time together.

"If every day were like this, it would be wonderful," Natan said while laughing.

Jones nodded. "Unfortunately, tomorrow is Sunday."

Natan immediately frowned.

"Don't remind me."

That night, Natan already had a plan. He wanted to sleep longer on Sunday morning and then play with his friends again.

However, his plan did not go as he had expected.

On Sunday morning, his mother's voice came from outside his room.

"Natan, wake up. We need to get ready for church."

Natan replied, "Mom, I'm tired."

His mother answered, "You have already slept for quite a long time, Natan. So, come on. We have to go to church."

"But it's Sunday. I want to rest," Natan replied.

His mother entered the room and sat beside his bed.

"Natan, do you know why we go to church every Sunday?"

Natan shook his head.

"Because God always gives us time and life. We come to church to worship, give thanks, and draw closer to Him."

Natan remained silent.

"But, Mom... I only have two days to rest."

His mother gave him a gentle smile.

"I understand that you are tired. But do not let your busy life make you forget God."

Natan suddenly became silent.

He still felt that going to church would take away his time to rest.

Finally, that morning, Natan decided not to go.

He sent a message to Jones and invited him to play. Not long afterward, Jones, Darwin, and Mateo arrived.

They played just as they had the day before. However, this time, Natan felt slightly different.

Suddenly, Darwin said, "I went to church with my family this morning."

Natan smiled slightly and asked Darwin, "So, did you lose your time to play?"

Darwin shook his head.

"No."

Natan asked again, "Why?"

Darwin sat on a bench and answered calmly.

"Because I do not feel like I lost any time. Instead, I feel that I gained time to pause from all my busy activities."

Natan became silent.

Darwin continued, "I also have many activities throughout the week. Sometimes I feel tired. But when I am at church, I can be calm and remember God."

Mateo nodded.

"That's true. We often think that resting means sleeping or playing. However, our hearts also need rest."

Natan did not answer immediately.

He looked at his two friends.

"Don't you ever want to spend Sunday just playing?" he asked.

"Of course we do," Mateo answered. "But that does not mean we should forget God."

Those words made Natan think.

They continued playing that day. However, for the first time, Natan did not feel as happy as he usually did.

When the afternoon came, he went home.

In his room, Natan looked at the calendar hanging on the wall. Almost every day had an activity written on it.

Monday: School.

Tuesday: School activities.

Wednesday: Assignments.

Thursday: Activities.

Friday: School.

Saturday: Playing.

Then he looked at the note written on Sunday: Church.

Natan stared at the word for a long time.

All this time, he had considered that word a reminder of something that took away his holiday.

However, this time, he began to see it differently.

He remembered his mother's words:

"Do not let your busy life make you forget God."

He also remembered Darwin's words:

"Our hearts also need rest."

Natan then took the Bible that was lying on his desk.

He opened it and read several passages that reminded him to be grateful to God.

Natan began to realize that all this time, he had been too focused on what he wanted to do.

He wanted to play.

He wanted to sleep longer.

He wanted to enjoy his free time.

But he rarely thought about one important question:

Had he made time for God, who had given him the opportunity to do all those things?

Natan closed his Bible.

For the first time, he felt that perhaps he had been looking at Sunday from the wrong perspective.

Sunday was not only about taking a break from school.

It could also be an opportunity to pause from all the busyness of life and remember God.

The following day, Natan met his three friends at school again.

"Tomorrow is Sunday again," Jones said with a smile. "Do you want to play?"

Natan smiled.

"Yes."

"But I will go to church first."

Jones, Darwin, and Mateo were silent for a few seconds.

"Are you serious?" Mateo asked.

Natan nodded.

"I have just realized that all this time, I was wrong to think of church as something that took away my holiday."

Darwin smiled and asked, "And now?"

Natan answered, "Now I understand that spending time with God is not wasted time."

Mateo patted Natan on the shoulder.

"Good."

Natan laughed.

He knew that his life would not suddenly become perfect. He would still feel tired. He would still want to play. He would still need time to rest.

However, he no longer wanted to use his busy schedule as an excuse to forget God.

The following Sunday, Natan woke up earlier.

For the first time, he did not feel forced when he put on his clothes to go to church.

He walked with his family with a different feeling in his heart.

The Sunday he once considered a day to avoid going to church now had a new meaning for him.

Natan finally understood that life was not only about completing activities, seeking enjoyment, or spending time only for himself.

Now he knew that there was a time to study, a time to work, a time to play, a time to rest, and a time to come before God with a grateful heart.

That day felt different, not because he did not play, and not because he did not rest.

It felt different because he understood the true meaning of Sunday.

On that day, Natan learned and understood that time spent with God was not wasted time. Instead, it was time that helped him remember once again who had always been with him throughout his life.